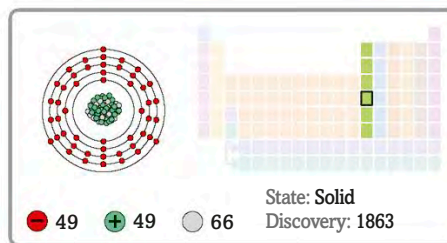


49
In

Indium



The Boron Group

Forms



Sphalerite

When bent, indium produces a **“tin cry”** – a sound similar to a **scream**.

Pure indium mould cast in a laboratory



This zinc mineral is the main source of indium.

Pure indium is soft enough to draw lines on paper.

Uses

This touchscreen has a grid of very thin, transparent wires made of indium tin oxide.



Touchscreen tablet

Welder's goggles

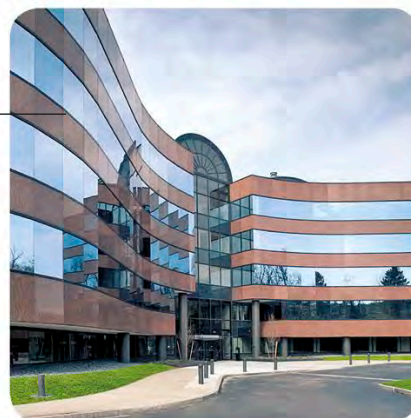


Protective goggles coated with indium stop the heat damaging the welder's eyes.

This glass coated with indium oxide is shiny but still lets light through.



The tiny electronic switches inside this transistor contain indium.



Windows in a building

Indium is named after indigo, which is the colour of the light its atoms release when electrified. Its minerals are rare, and most of the metal is obtained from lead and zinc ores, such as **sphalerite**. **Pure indium** is very soft, and the element is mostly used in compound

form. For example, a compound called indium tin oxide used on a **touchscreen** allows the computer to detect when a finger makes contact with the screen. Indium is also required in microchips, and to produce **welder's goggles** and **windows** that are heat- and glare-proof.